For an average person, it only takes one look at a tomato or garlic pod for visions of pasta or curry to flood the mind. But French artist-designer José Lévy and Deepika Jindal of Arttd'inox, aren't most people; they see things differently. Their latest collaboration, Playful Playfood that takes the humble contents of a kitchen and gives them a high-gloss, surrealist appeal, is a case in point. Turns out, when you stop chopping and start polishing them into sculptural art, the results are spectacular.

Steel with a Soul

Walking into the exhibition, a stack of tomato vases take centre stage—and your eyes, they do a double take. Made of hyper-reflective stainless steel, they act like mirrors, distorting and shifting as you walk past. It's design that refuses to sit still or look the same way twice.

Eggplants to Elephants

The collection doesn't stop at the salad bowl. Expect to see gleaming eggplants, garlic pods and even peanuts reimagined as heavy-metal chic. These sit alongside more abstract creations such as elephant candleholders and lamps that mimic the rugged texture of a tree bark. There is a distinct Franco Japanese influence here, clean, poetic and fluid, yet





it's all filtered through a vibrant Indian lens. The result is a series of objects that feel paradoxically heavy yet weightless, as if the metal itself is breathing.

Love Letter to the Desi Kitchen

Lévy admits he was hooked by the exuberant world of Indian hospitality and that signature cultural generosity. He wanted to experiment with what happens when you trap the soft, organic curve of a vegetable inside the rigid, cold brilliance of steel. The result is a strange, luminous tension. You know it's a vegetable, yet you feel like you're seeing its true form for the first time.

Beyond the Utilitarian

For Deepika Jindal, this wasn't just about making pretty objects; it was about rebranding a material. In India, stainless steel is everywhere, usually in the form of a reliable, unglamorous *tiffin* or *thali*. This collection pushes Arttd'inox into the realm of high design, proving that steel can be as precious as marble and as expressive as an artist's canvas.

Vegetable-themed decor might sound like a fleeting trend, but there's a permanence to these pieces that feels deliberate. Clearly, the best home decor inspiration isn't found in a glossy catalogue, it's been hiding in your vegetable basket all along.